# Project Plan

## Canadian Ticketing Fee Transparency Standard Implementation

*Stakeholder map   Project phases   Risk register   May 2026*

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| Project name | Canadian Ticketing Fee Transparency Standard |
| Prepared by | Simran Saran, Project Analyst |
| Date | May 2026 |
| Project objective | Implement mandatory fee transparency standards for all concert ticket sales in Canada by Q4 2027 |
| Project sponsor | Federal consumer protection authority |
| Key stakeholders | Ticketing platforms, venues, artists, consumers, regulators, payment processors |
| Estimated duration | 18 months from regulatory mandate to full compliance |
| Risk level | High: regulatory and stakeholder complexity |

## Project Overview

This project plan covers the implementation of a mandatory fee transparency standard for concert ticket sales across Canada. The regulatory framework is clear from the business analysis. What this document addresses is how you actually get from the current state, where 4 of 5 major platforms hide fees until checkout to a future state where every Canadian consumer sees the full price before they make a purchase decision.

This is not a simple technology project. It is a regulatory change management project involving multiple platforms, multiple levels of government, industry stakeholders with competing interests, and a consumer base that has been conditioned to accept the current system. The implementation plan has to account for all of that.

## Stakeholder Map

| Stakeholder | Influence | Position | Key concern | Engagement approach |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Ticketmaster Canada and Live Nation | Very High | Resistant | Fee revenue is 35 to 40% of gross ticketing revenue | Phased compliance timeline. Revenue impact modelling showing long-term consumer trust benefit. |

| Stakeholder | Influence | Position | Key concern | Engagement approach |
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| Canadian Venues | High | Neutral to Resistant | Facility fees fund operations. Public scrutiny may create pressure to reduce them. | Require plain language disclosure of what fees cover rather than mandatory reduction. |
| Artists and Management | Medium | Supportive | Hidden fees damage fan relationships and tour revenue | Enlist as public advocates. High profile artist support accelerates momentum. |
| Canadian Consumers | Medium | Strongly Supportive | Current system feels deceptive. Trust in platforms is low. | Public consultation process. Consumer advocacy group coalition. |
| Federal Regulator | Very High | Supportive | Jurisdictional clarity on which body regulates ticketing | Clear legislative mandate with defined enforcement powers. |
| Provincial Consumer Offices | High | Supportive | Inconsistent provincial standards create compliance complexity | Federal minimum standard with provincial opt-in enhancement. |
| Independent Platforms | Low | Strongly Supportive | Currently disadvantaged in search vs larger platforms | All-in price display creates level playing field. Smaller platforms benefit. |
| Payment Processors | Medium | Neutral | Regulatory scope creep into payment processing fees | Require clear separation of genuine processing costs from platform revenue fees. |

## Project Phases

### Phase 1: Regulatory mandate and stakeholder consultation (Months 1 to 4)

The first phase establishes the legal and regulatory foundation. Without a clear mandate from the federal government the project has no enforcement mechanism and platform compliance is voluntary. This phase runs the public consultation process, drafts the regulatory standard, and tables the mandate for approval.

| Milestone | Owner | Timeline | Success measure |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| Public consultation launched — online survey and stakeholder submissions open | Federal regulator | Month 1 | Minimum 500 consumer submissions. All major platforms submit formal response. |

| Milestone | Owner | Timeline | Success measure |
|---|---|---|---|
| Industry working group established | Project sponsor | Month 2 | Representatives from Ticketmaster, top 3 venues, 2 artist management firms, 2 consumer advocacy groups confirmed |
| Draft regulatory standard published for comment | Legal team | Month 3 | Standard covers all 7 Must Have requirements. Published in Canada Gazette. |
| Regulatory mandate tabled and approved | Government | Month 4 | Mandate passed with defined compliance deadline of 12 months from approval date |

### Phase 2: Platform compliance development (Months 5 to 12)

Phase 2 is where the platforms build what is required. Large platforms; Ticketmaster, StubHub, SeatGeek have 12 months from regulatory mandate to achieve full compliance. Smaller platforms have 18 months. This phase includes technical specification development, API documentation release, and compliance testing.

| Milestone | Owner | Timeline | Success measure |
|---|---|---|---|
| Technical specification document published — API requirements and fee display standards | Regulator and technical working group | Month 5 | Specification covers all platform types. Developer documentation complete. |
| Large platform compliance declarations submitted | Ticketmaster, StubHub, SeatGeek | Month 8 | Self-certification submitted. Compliance checklist completed and signed. |
| Consumer testing of new fee display systems | Independent consumer research firm | Month 10 | Minimum 200 consumer testers across age groups and geographies. 80% comprehension rate on fee breakdown. |
| Large platform compliance verified | Regulator | Month 12 | Random audit of 50 transactions per platform. 100% show all-in price at ticket selection. |

### Phase 3: Monitoring and enforcement (Month 13 onwards)

Once compliance is achieved the project transitions to ongoing monitoring. This phase establishes the audit framework, the consumer complaint mechanism, and the enforcement escalation process for non-compliant platforms.

| Activity | Frequency | Owner | Escalation trigger |
|---|---|---|---|
| Random transaction audit, 50 transactions per platform | Quarterly | Regulator | Any fee disclosed at checkout that was not shown at ticket selection |
| Consumer complaint review | Monthly | Regulator | More than 10 complaints about a single platform in any month triggers formal investigation |
| Annual fee report publication | Annual | All platforms by Jan 31 | Failure to publish triggers $50,000 administrative penalty |
| Small platform compliance verification | Month 18 | Regulator | 100% of platforms below the large platform threshold verified |

## Risk Register

| Risk ID | Risk | Likelihood | Consequence | Rating | Mitigation |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| RSK-001 | Ticketmaster challenges mandate legally, 12 to 18 month delay | High | High | **Critical** | Build 18-month delay buffer. Model EU and Australian regulatory precedent. |
| RSK-002 | Platforms comply technically but redesign display to minimize consumer comprehension | High | Medium | High | Require minimum font size, pla language standards, and consumer testing in complianc verification. |
| RSK-003 | Platforms absorb fee into face value rather than itemise | Medium | High | High | Require fee itemisation not jus all-in price. Face value must be verifiable against organiser filir |
| RSK-004 | Federal and provincial jurisdiction dispute stalls national standard | Medium | High | High | Federal minimum standard wit provincial opt-in. Model after national food labelling framework. |
| RSK-007 | Smaller platforms lack technical resources for same timeline | High | Low | Medium | Two-tier timeline. Large platforms 12 months. Small platforms 18 months. Compliance toolkit provided. |
| RSK-008 | Regulatory body lacks enforcement budget to monitor compliance | Medium | High | High | Self-certification with random audit. Platform-funded compliance levy covers monitoring costs. |

| Risk ID | Risk | Likelihood | Consequence | Rating | Mitigation |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| RSK-010 | Media cycle moves on reducing political pressure to act | Medium | Medium | Medium | Consumer advocacy coalition maintains ongoing pressure. Annual fee report keeps issue visible. |

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| Prepared by | Simran Saran |
| Targeting | Business Analyst and Project Management roles across Canada |
| Series | Portfolio Project |